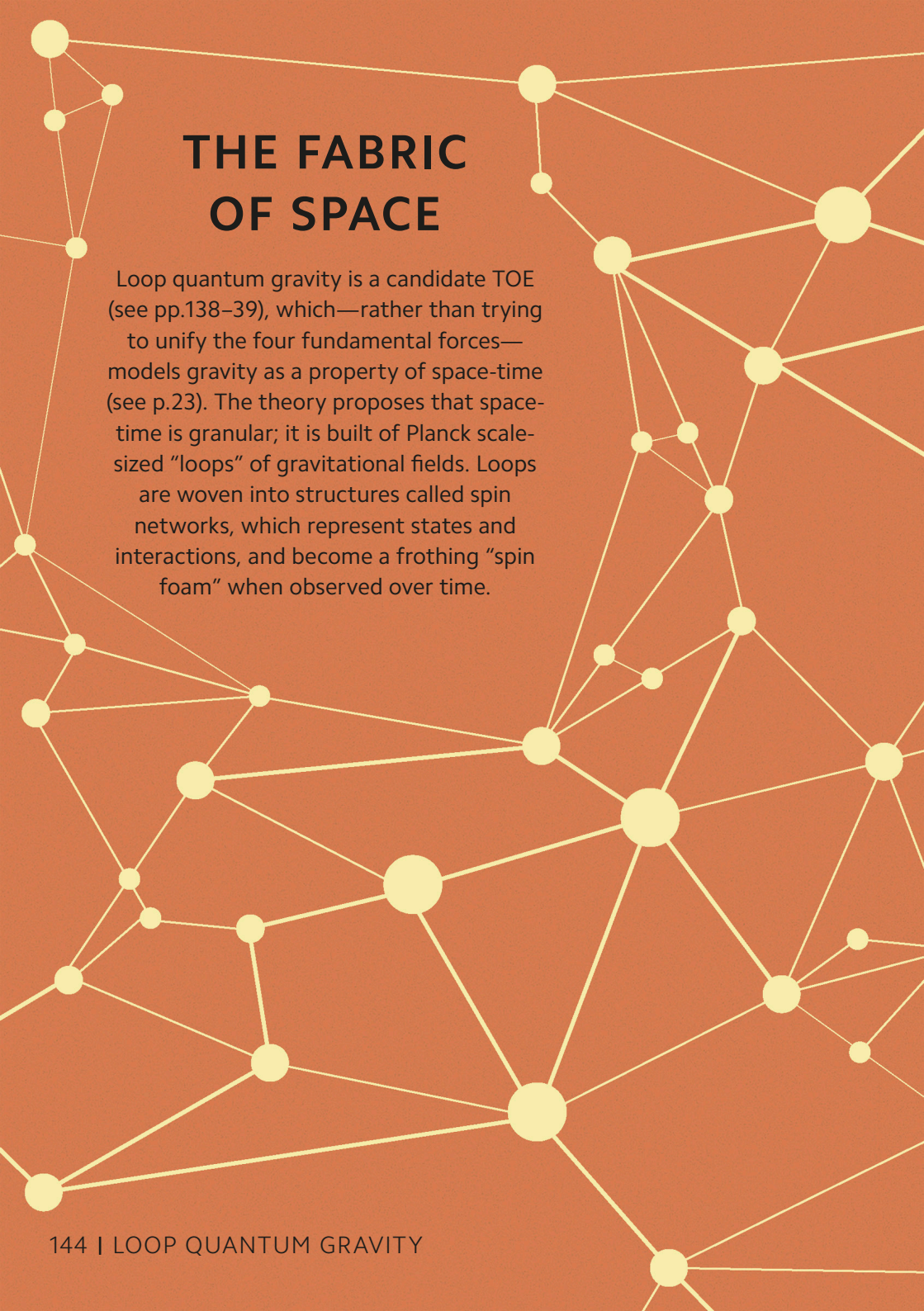


The background of the entire page is a solid orange color. Overlaid on this background is a complex, abstract network of thin yellow lines. These lines connect various-sized yellow circles of different diameters. The circles are scattered across the page, with some appearing as isolated nodes and others as part of larger, more interconnected clusters. The lines themselves form a web-like structure, with some being straight and others slightly curved, creating a sense of dynamic movement and interconnectedness. The overall effect is reminiscent of a molecular structure, a neural network, or perhaps a map of a complex system.

THE FABRIC OF SPACE

Loop quantum gravity is a candidate TOE (see pp.138–39), which—rather than trying to unify the four fundamental forces—models gravity as a property of space-time (see p.23). The theory proposes that space-time is granular; it is built of Planck scale-sized “loops” of gravitational fields. Loops are woven into structures called spin networks, which represent states and interactions, and become a frothing “spin foam” when observed over time.